in preventing the use of Myanmar territory for anti-India activity.

Commercial Cooperation

1. A bilateral Trade Agreement was signed in 1970.
2. India is the fifth largest trading partner of Myanmar but trade remains below potential.
3. India's exports to Myanmar include sugar pharmaceuticals, etc.
4. India is presently the tenth largest investor with an approved investment of US$ 740.64 million.
5. Most India's investments have been in oil & gas sector. Indian companies have evinced interest in investing in Myanmar and major contracts have been won by Indian companies.
6. Besides normal trade, both sides have also taken steps to bolster trade across the land border. Cooperation in the banking sector is crucial for investment and trade. United Bank of India signed banking agreements with banks of Myanmar (MFTR, MICB, MEB, and 9 private banks) to facilitate bilateral trade
7. Myanmar is an important partner in our energy relations with other countries in the region.

Culture relations

India and Myanmar share close cultural ties and a sense of deep kinship given India's Buddhist heritage.

1. Restoration of the Ananda Temple in Bagan
2. GOI donation of a 16 foot replica of the Sarnath Buddha Statue which has been installed at the premises of Shwedagon Pagoda in Yangon.
3. The 'Samvad-II' Interfaith dialogue was held on 6-7 August 2017, Yangon.
4. ICCR and Sitagu International Buddhist Academy organised an International Conference on Buddhist Cultural Heritage
5. India has responded to Myanmar's interest in restoring and renovating two historic temples in Bodh Gaya built by Myanmar rulers King Mindon and King Baygyidaw. These temples and inscriptions will now be restored with the assistance of the Archaeological Survey of India as a bilateral friendship project.

Indian diaspora

1. The origin of the Indian community in Myanmar is traced to the mid-19th century with the advent of the British rule in Lower Burma in 1852.
2. The two cities Yangon and Mandalay had a dominating presence of Indians in civil services, education, trade and commerce during the British rule.

Bilateral Cooperation in Regional/Sub-regional context

ASEAN: As the only ASEAN country which shares a land border with India, Myanmar is a bridge between India and ASEAN.

BIMSTEC: Myanmar is a signatory to the BIMSTEC Free Trade Agreement. Myanmar is the lead country for the energy sector. Myanmar trades mostly with Thailand and India in the BIMSTEC region. Myanmar's major exports to India are agricultural products like beans, pulses and maize and forest products such as teak and hardwoods. Its imports from India include chemical products, pharmaceuticals,

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